Social Curiosity: Study 2 (Circle Slips) (#124032)

Authors
This pre-registration is currently anonymous to enable blind peer-review.
It has 2 authors.

Pre-registered on:
2023/03/04 18:03 (PT)

1) Have any data been collected for this study already?
No, no data have been collected for this study yet.

2) What's the main question being asked or hypothesis being tested in this study?
Do preschool-aged children seek out information about how others evaluated them? We hypothesize that 3- and 4-year-old children care about how an adult evaluated a tracing of theirs, and deliberately seek out such information. Specifically, we predict that participants who have the chance to view an evaluation of their own tracing will be more likely to "peek" at it than participants who have the chance to view an evaluation of another individual's tracing.

3) Describe the key dependent variable(s) specifying how they will be measured.
After an experimenter evaluates the participant's and another child's (i.e., "Jordan", an unfamiliar, gender-matched child to the participant) tracings, they will leave the experimental room with either the child's or Jordan's evaluated tracing within a folder on a table in front of the participant. The key dependent variable is whether or not children peek at the folder when the experimenter is away.

4) How many and which conditions will participants be assigned to?
Children will be randomly assigned to either the Self condition or Other condition (between-subjects). Children will make a tracing (either of a tree or a bird, counterbalanced) then be shown another unfamiliar child's tracing (either a tree or bird, whichever the child did not trace). The two tracings will be placed inside of separate folders and evaluated out of sight.

After evaluation, the experimenter will leave behind one of the folders on the table in front of the child. The key condition difference is which folder the children were left with: either the one containing their own tracing (Self condition), or the other child's tracing (Other condition). Children will be left alone in the room for a total of three minutes.

5) Specify exactly which analyses you will conduct to examine the main question/hypothesis.
We will use a Fisher's Exact Test to test for a condition difference on whether children peeked at the folder during the test phase.

6) Describe exactly how outliers will be defined and handled, and your precise rule(s) for excluding observations.
Participants will be excluded for interference (e.g., teachers, children, or other individuals), experimenter error (e.g., large deviations from the study script), failure to complete the study, peeking at the folder prior to the delay phase, having parent-reported developmental delays, or technical errors (e.g., video does not record).

7) How many observations will be collected or what will determine sample size? No need to justify decision, but be precise about exactly how the number will be determined.
We plan to run 36 children between the ages of 3;0 to 5;0 (year;month) in each condition (72 total).

8) Anything else you would like to pre-register? (e.g., secondary analyses, variables collected for exploratory purposes, unusual analyses planned?)
As an exploratory analysis, we may test for a condition difference on children's time taken before peeking at the folder within the three minute window. We will code children's peektime as three minutes if they did not peek during the three minute window (as done in previous work, see Kidd et al. (2013)).

We may also explore the effect of age both on our main analysis (proportion of children peeking) and time-to-peek (above).